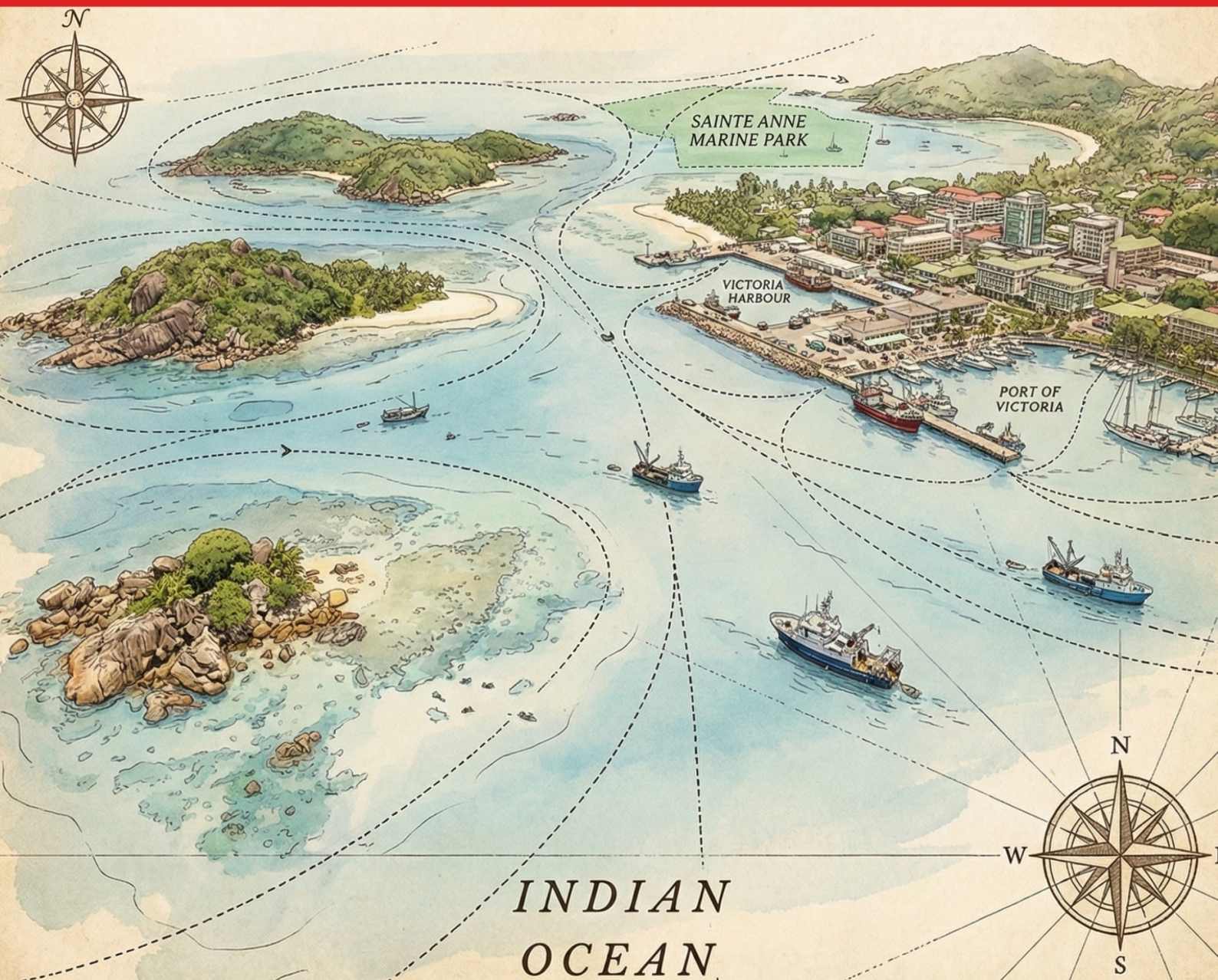




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MAPPING WORLD:

SEYCHELLES



- Seychelles is a sovereign island country and [archipelagic state](#) comprising 115 islands, known for its high human development, blue economy focus, and strategic maritime location in the Indian Ocean.

Located in:

- **Western Indian Ocean**, about 1,500 km east of mainland Africa
- **Neighbours:** Maldives, Mauritius, Madagascar, Comoros, Réunion (France)

Capital: Victoria (on Mahé Island)

Key geographical features:

- **Archipelagic composition:** 115 islands grouped into Inner (granitic) and Outer (coralline) islands.
- **Granitic islands** (Mahé, Praslin, La Digue): among the oldest oceanic granite formations in the world.
- **Coral atolls and reef systems:** support rich marine biodiversity and the blue economy.

STRAIT OF HORMUZ



- The Strait of Hormuz is the world's most vital **oil transit chokepoint**. It is a narrow maritime passage that serves as the only sea exit for the Persian Gulf, linking it to the Gulf of Oman and the open ocean.

Located In: It is situated in the [Middle East](#), separating the northern coast of Iran from the Arabian Peninsula.

- Links the Persian Gulf to the Indian Ocean through the Gulf of Oman.

Neighbouring Nations:

- **Iran:** Controls the northern coastline and several strategic islands (Qeshm, Hormuz, Larak).
- **Oman:** Controls the southern coast via the [Musandam Peninsula](#) exclave.
- **United Arab Emirates (UAE):** Located to the south and west; home to major ports like Fujairah.

Key Geographical Features:

- **Shipping Lanes:** Due to [shallow waters](#) near the coast, tankers must use two **3-km wide shipping lanes** (one inbound, one outbound) separated by a 2-km buffer zone.
- **Strategic Islands:** Iran maintains a heavy military presence on islands like **Abu Musa** and the **Greater and Lesser Tunbs**, which allow for [de facto control](#) over the shipping channels.
- **Bathymetry:** The water is deep enough (60–100 meters) to handle the world's largest **VLCCs (Very Large Crude Carriers)**, making it irreplaceable for bulk energy transport.

THE DRUZHBA OIL PIPELINE



- The **Druzhba Pipeline** (translating to Friendship in English) is one of the world's longest and largest crude oil pipeline networks.
- Established during the [Soviet era](#), it serves as the primary artery for transporting Russian and Kazakh oil to the industrial heartlands of Central and Eastern Europe.

Located In:

- The network originates in **Almetyevsk, Tatarstan (Russia)**, where it collects oil from Western Siberia, the Urals, and the [Caspian Sea](#).
- It spans approximately **4,000 kilometers**, crossing the Russia-Belarus border before splitting into two massive branches.

States/Countries it Goes Through:

- **Russia:** The starting point and primary source.
- **Belarus:** The central transit hub at Mazyr where the line splits.
- **Northern Branch:** Travels through **Poland** to reach **Germany**.
- **Southern Branch:** Travels through **Ukraine** to supply **Hungary, Slovakia, and the Czech Republic**.

MEXICO



- Mexico, officially called the **United Mexican States (Estados Unidos Mexicanos)**, is a federal republic located in **southern North America**.
- It is one of the largest economies in Latin America and has a diverse cultural, historical, and ecological landscape.

Capital:

- Mexico City

Bordering Nations:

- United States to the north.
- Guatemala and Belize to the southeast.
- Bounded by the **Pacific Ocean** (west & south) and the Gulf of Mexico and Caribbean Sea (east).

Key Geological Features:

- Part of the **Pacific Ring of Fire**, making it highly prone to earthquakes and volcanic activity.
- Major mountain systems include Sierra Madre Occidental, Sierra Madre Oriental, and the Trans-Mexican Volcanic Belt (Cordillera Neo-Volcánica).
- Home to active and high volcanoes such as **Popocatepetl** and **Citlaltépetl (Pico de Orizaba)**.
- Diverse physiographic regions including the **Mexican Plateau**, Yucatán Peninsula, Baja California Peninsula, and coastal plains.
- Major rivers include **Río Bravo (Rio Grande)**, Grijalva, and Balsas.

ISRAEL



- Israel is a resilient democracy located at the eastern end of the **Mediterranean Sea** in **West Asia** (the Levant).
- Established in 1948, it is the world's only Jewish-majority nation and is recognized as a global leader in high-tech innovation, water management, and defense systems.

Capital:

- **Jerusalem** is the seat of the **Israeli government**, including the Knesset (Parliament) and the Supreme Court.

Bordering Nations:

- Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, West Bank, Egypt, Gaza Strip, and Mediterranean Sea.

Key Features:

- **Four Regions:** The country consists of the Mediterranean coastal plain, the central hill regions (Galilee, Samaria, Judea), the **Great Rift Valley**, and the **Negev Desert** in the south.
- **The Dead Sea:** Located in the Jordan Rift Valley, it is the **lowest point on Earth's surface** (approx. 430m below sea level) and is famous for its extreme salinity.
- **Sea of Galilee (Lake Tiberias):** Israel's largest freshwater lake and a primary water source.
- **Tectonic Setting:** Israel sits on the **Dead Sea Transform fault system**, a boundary between the African and Arabian plates, leading to significant geological activity.
- **Water Scarcity:** Despite having no navigable rivers and chronic water shortages, Israel has pioneered **desalination** and drip irrigation technologies.

THE CHAGOS ISLANDS



- The Chagos Islands, also known as the Chagos Archipelago, is a group of seven atolls comprising more than 60 individual tropical islands. It is officially administered as the [British Indian Ocean Territory \(BIOT\)](#), though its sovereignty is heavily contested.

Located In:

- The archipelago is situated in the **Indian Ocean**, approximately 500 kilometers south of the Maldives.
- It sits atop the [Chagos–Laccadive Ridge](#), a massive submarine mountain range.

Origin:

- The islands are coralline rock structures formed by volcanic activity over the Réunion hotspot.
- They consist of low-lying atolls set around central lagoons, including the **Great Chagos Bank**, which is the world's largest [atoll structure](#).

Features:

- Diego Garcia:** The largest and most significant island, hosting a critical joint UK-US naval and air support facility.
- Biodiversity:** Home to some of the world's most resilient coral reefs and the world's largest coral atoll.
- Strategic Location:** Its mid-ocean position provides a vital military "foothold" for monitoring the [Indian Ocean](#) and surrounding regions.
- Demographics:** Currently, there is no permanent civilian population; the islands are inhabited only by military personnel and contractors.

NANDHAUR WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

Nandhaur Wildlife Sanctuary is a protected forest area forming part of the Terai Arc Landscape, serving as a crucial [biodiversity corridor](#) between India and Nepal.

Located in:

- Situated in **Nainital district, Uttarakhand**.
- Lies between the **Gola and Sharda Rivers**.

- Connects forests of Ramnagar with [Shuklaphanta National Park](#) in Nepal.

History:

- Established in **2012**.
- Part of the **Shivalik Elephant Reserve (since 2002)**.
- Recently prescribed by the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)** as Uttarakhand's third Tiger Reserve.

Key Features:

- Dominated by [Sal forests](#) with over 100 tree species including shisham, bamboo, teak, and chir pine.
- Major fauna include tiger, leopard, Asian elephant, and sloth bear.
- Functions as an ecological corridor in the Terai-Bhabar region.

About Smooth-Coated Otter:

- The smooth-coated otter is a semi-aquatic mammal and one of the largest otter species in Asia, known for its sleek body and strong swimming ability.

Scientific Name: *Lutrogale perspicillata*

Conservation Status

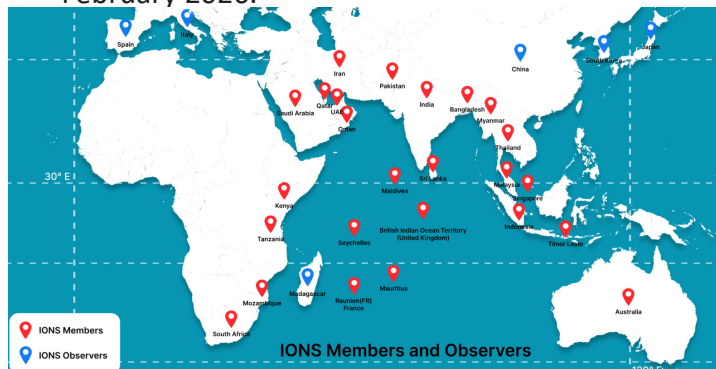
- Listed as Vulnerable on the International Union for Conservation of Nature ([IUCN](#)) Red List.

Habitat

- Found in freshwater rivers, wetlands, mangroves, and estuaries.
- Requires clean water bodies with abundant fish and amphibians.
- Acts as a bio-indicator species, indicating [healthy aquatic ecosystems](#).

INDIAN OCEAN NAVAL SYMPOSIUM (IONS)

- India assumed the Chairmanship of the [Indian Ocean Naval Symposium \(IONS\)](#) during the 9th Conclave of Chiefs held in Visakhapatnam in February 2026.



- The **Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS)** is a **voluntary, inclusive and multilateral maritime**

forum that promotes cooperation among navies of the Indian Ocean Region (IOR).

Established in:

- Established in 2008.
- Initiated by the [Indian Navy](#) to strengthen maritime cooperation among Indian Ocean littoral states.

History:

- India held the **inaugural chairmanship (2008–2010)**.
- Successive chairmanships included UAE, South Africa, Australia, Bangladesh, Iran, France and Thailand.
- In **2026**, India reassumed chairmanship, signalling renewed momentum for regional maritime cooperation.

Members:

- Around **25 member nations** from the [Indian Ocean](#) Region.
- Includes **observer countries and other maritime partners**, with participation spanning from the Atlantic to the Pacific.

Aim:

- To enhance collaboration among regional navies for maintaining peace, stability and secure sea lanes in the Indian Ocean.
- To promote interoperability, professional exchanges and coordinated responses to [humanitarian and security challenges](#).

Key Functions:

- Conducts Conclaves of Chiefs of Navies for strategic dialogue:** Provides a high-level platform where naval leaders discuss regional maritime challenges, security cooperation and future collaborative strategies.
- Facilitates maritime exercises (IMEX):** Organises joint drills and officer interactions to improve interoperability, operational understanding and confidence among participating navies.
- Operates through three specialised Working Groups:**

Dedicated groups translate strategic decisions into practical cooperation in key maritime domains.

- [Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief \(HADR\)](#): Develops coordination mechanisms and best practices for rapid response during natural disasters and humanitarian crises at sea.
- [Maritime Security \(MARSEC\)](#): Focuses on tackling piracy, terrorism, trafficking and other

non-traditional maritime threats through shared experiences and cooperation.

- [Information Sharing & Interoperability \(IS&I\)](#): Enhances real-time information exchange and compatible procedures to improve joint maritime operations and situational awareness.
- Promotes maritime domain awareness:** Encourages sharing of maritime data and coordinated surveillance to ensure safer sea lanes and effective monitoring of activities.
- Strengthens institutional collaboration:** Uses digital systems, training programmes and workshops to improve continuous engagement and long-term institutional cooperation among navies.

TAKESHIMA/DOKDO ISLANDS



- The territory is a cluster of small, rocky outcroppings located in the **Sea of Japan** (referred to as the **East Sea** by South Korea).
- Composition:** It consists of two main volcanic islets—**Dongdo** (East Island) and **Seodo** (West Island)—along with roughly 30 to 90 smaller rocks and reefs.
- Geographical Position:**
 - The islands lie roughly equidistant between the two nations but are physically closer to the [South Korean island](#) of **Ulleungdo** (approx. 87 km) than to Japan's **Oki Islands** (approx. 157 km).

Features:

- Terrain:** Volcanic rocks formed in the Cenozoic era. They feature steep cliffs, numerous sea caves, and a harsh, humid climate.
- Fisheries:** The surrounding waters are a [Goldilocks zone](#) where warm and cold ocean currents meet, creating one of the world's most fertile fishing grounds for squid, pollock, and cod.
- Energy Potential:** Recent geological surveys suggest the seabed may hold **600 million tons of gas hydrates** (often called fire ice).
- This natural gas resource is estimated to be

worth nearly **\$10 billion annually**, making the islands a strategic energy asset.

ARMENIA



- Armenia is a landlocked country in the South Caucasus (Transcaucasia), located at the crossroads of Eastern Europe and Western Asia. It is one of the world's oldest centres of civilisation, with a long history shaped by empires, invasions, and modern geopolitical conflicts.

Capital: Yerevan

Neighbouring nations:

- Armenia shares borders with Georgia, Azerbaijan, Iran, and Turkey
- It also borders **Nakhchivan**, an exclave of [Azerbaijan](#), to the southwest.

Key geological and physical features:

- Mountainous terrain:** Armenia lies on the **Armenian Highland**, with an average elevation of about 1,800 metres, making it one of the most mountainous countries in the region.
- Lesser Caucasus ranges:** Multiple mountain chains (Bazum, Pambak, Vardenis, etc.) dominate the landscape, interspersed with volcanic plateaus and deep valleys.
- Volcanic origin:** Much of the land is formed from ancient lava flows, resulting in mineral-rich but stone-heavy soils.
- Lake Sevan:** One of the largest high-altitude freshwater lakes in Eurasia, crucial for irrigation, hydropower, and climate regulation.
- Seismic vulnerability:** Armenia lies in an active seismic zone, highlighted by the devastating **1988 Spitak earthquake**.
- Continental climate:** Hot, dry summers and cold winters, with sharp climatic variation by altitude.

MOUNT ACONCAGUA

summitted Mount Aconcagua in Argentina as part of her 7-[Summit Mountaineering Expedition](#).



- Mount Aconcagua is the highest mountain in South America and the Western Hemisphere, and the tallest peak outside Asia. With an elevation of about 22,831 feet (6,959 m), it is one of the most challenging non-technical climbs among the Seven Summits.

Located in: Argentina

- Situated in **western Mendoza Province**, near the **Argentina–Chile border**
- Part of the **Southern Andes** mountain range

Geological features:

- Volcanic origin**, though it is **not an active volcano**.
- Comprises **two summits (North and South)** connected by a ridge called Cresta del Guanaco.
- Formed by complex tectonic **uplift of the Andes**, rather than volcanic cone-building.
- Exhibits extreme conditions such as **thin air, high winds, and sub-zero temperatures**, making altitude sickness a major challenge.

Significance:

- Geographical:** Highest point in the Western Hemisphere and [Southern Hemisphere](#).
- Mountaineering:** One of the **Seven Summits**, attracting climbers worldwide.

JAPAN



Japan is a constitutional monarchy with a parliamentary system, governed under the 1947 Constitution, where the Emperor is a ceremonial head of state and real executive power rests with the Prime Minister and the Cabinet.

Location:

- An island nation in East Asia, located in the western North Pacific Ocean
- Lies off the east coast of the [Asian continent](#), forming a northeast–southwest arc

Capital: Tokyo.

Neighbouring Countries / Seas:

- Sea of Japan (East Sea), East China Sea, Pacific Ocean, and [Sea of Okhotsk](#).

Key Geological & Physical Features

- Composed mainly of **four major islands**: Hokkaido, Honshu (largest), Shikoku, Kyushu.
- Highly **mountainous terrain** (over 80% mountains).
- Located on the [Pacific Ring of Fire](#) → frequent **earthquakes and volcanic activity**.
- **Mount Fuji (3,776 m)** – highest peak and iconic stratovolcano.
- Short, swift rivers; narrow coastal plains with dense population.
- Tectonically shaped by the **Pacific and Philippine plates** subducting beneath the [Eurasian Plate](#).

BANGLADESH



- Bangladesh is a South Asian country that emerged as an independent nation in 1971 after the Liberation War against Pakistan.

Location: It is located in [South Asia](#), forming part of the historical Bengal region.

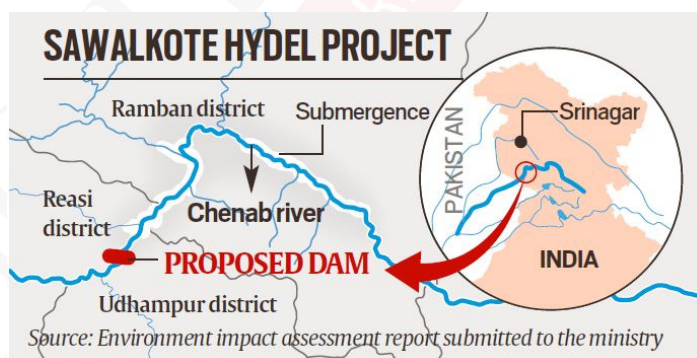
Bordering Nations:

- **India** (West Bengal, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram) – on three sides
- **Myanmar (Burma)** – southeast
- Opens to the **Bay of Bengal** in the south

Key Geographical & Geological Features:

- **Deltaic Country:** Situated in the vast delta of the [Ganges \(Padma\), Brahmaputra \(Jamuna\), and Meghna rivers](#) – one of the largest river deltas in the world.
- **Low-Lying Terrain:** Majority of the land is less than 30 feet above sea level, making it highly flood-prone.
- **Sundarbans:** World's largest mangrove forest located in the southwest.
- **Chittagong Hill Tracts:** Hilly region in the southeast.
- **Highly Riverine System:** Rivers reshape the landscape frequently, causing both fertile soil deposits and devastating floods.
- One of the **most densely populated countries** in the world.

SAWALKOT HYDROELECTRIC PROJECT



- The **Sawalkot Hydroelectric Project** is a 1,856 MW [Run-of-the-River \(RoR\)](#) hydropower project being developed on the Chenab River in Jammu & Kashmir. It is the **largest hydropower project in J&K** and among the biggest in Northern India.
- The project is being implemented by National Hydroelectric Power Corporation (NHPC).

Location:

- **River:** Chenab River – A major tributary of the Indus, crucial for hydropower generation in the Himalayan region.
- **Basin:** Indus Basin ([Western Rivers system](#)) – Part of the western rivers allocated to India for non-consumptive use under treaty provisions.
- **Location:** Ramzan and Udhampur districts, Jammu & Kashmir.
- **Falls under India's share as per Indus Waters Treaty** – India can develop run-of-the-river projects on western rivers within specified design limits.

Key Features:

- **Installed Capacity: 1,856 MW** – Makes it the largest hydropower project in J&K, significantly boosting regional capacity.

- **Project Type: Run-of-the-River (RoR)** – Generates electricity using natural river flow without creating large storage reservoirs.
- **Dam Type: 192.5 m RCC Gravity Dam** – A strong concrete structure designed to withstand high Himalayan river pressures.
- **Power Infrastructure: Underground powerhouse with nine turbines** – Enhances security and efficiency while minimizing surface disturbance.
- **Annual Output: ~8,000 Million Units (MU)** – Capable of meeting substantial electricity demand, especially during winter shortages.
- **Environmental Clearance: Reaffirmed September 2025** – Approved after review by the Expert Appraisal Committee for compliance with norms.

TAMIL BRAHMI INSCRIPTIONS IN EGYPT



- The discovery refers to ancient Indian inscriptions—primarily in **Tamil Brahmi script**—found inside Egyptian tombs, indicating the presence of Indian visitors or traders in Roman-era Egypt.

Located In:

- The inscriptions were documented in six tombs within the **Valley of the Kings**, part of the Theban Necropolis along the [Nile River](#) in Egypt.

About Valley of the Kings:

- The Valley of the Kings is a major ancient Egyptian burial site where pharaohs of the New Kingdom were interred in rock-cut tombs deep within desert hills.

Located In:

- It lies on the west bank of the Nile River near modern-day Luxor in Upper Egypt, forming part of the ancient city of Thebes.
- In 1979, it was designated a [UNESCO World Heritage Site](#) as part of the Ancient Thebes complex.

History:

- **Period of Use:** Primarily used during the 18th,

19th, and 20th Dynasties (c. 1539–1075 BCE).

- **Royal Burials:** Served as the burial ground for pharaohs from Thutmose I to Ramses X, along with some queens and high officials.
- **Shift in Burial Practice:** New Kingdom rulers chose this hidden valley to prevent tomb robbery, moving away from [pyramid burials](#).
- **Architectural Features:** Tombs include descending corridors, pillared halls, burial chambers, and deep shafts designed to deter robbers.
- **Religious Significance:** Walls were decorated with funerary texts like the “Book of the Dead,” “Book of Gates,” and “Book of That Which Is in the Underworld,” guiding the king through the afterlife.
- **Archaeological Importance:** Over 60 tombs have been discovered, including the famous [tomb of Tutankhamun](#) (KV62).

REYNISFJARA BEACH

- Reynisfjara is a **world-famous black volcanic sand beach**, known for its dramatic geological formations and powerful Atlantic waves. It is considered one of Iceland’s most iconic natural landmarks.

Location:

- Situated near the town of Vík í Mýrdal in southern Iceland.
- Part of the Katla [UNESCO Global Geopark](#).
- Faces the North Atlantic Ocean along Iceland’s rugged south coast.

Origin:

- Formed from **volcanic basalt lava flows** that cooled rapidly upon contact with the ocean.
- The black sand is composed of eroded volcanic rock from nearby volcanoes like Eyjafjallajökull.
- The striking hexagonal basalt columns at Hálsanefshellir cave are products of **columnar jointing**, a volcanic cooling process.

Key Features:

- **Black Volcanic Sand:** Dark, charcoal-like sand created by pulverized basalt.
- **Reynisdrangar Sea Stacks:** Towering rock formations rising from the ocean.
- **Basalt Columns & Caves:** Natural geometric formations resembling organ pipes.
- **Sneaker Waves:** Sudden, powerful waves that surge inland unpredictably, making it one of Iceland’s most hazardous beaches.

Reason for Diminishing:

- **Persistent Easterly Winds:** Unlike usual

southwesterly winds, strong easterlies pushed sand westward along the coast.

- **Natural Barrier Effect:** The Reynisfjall mountain blocks westward sand movement, preventing replenishment.
- **High-Energy Atlantic Swells:** Heavy winter waves intensified coastal scouring.
- **Landslide & Structural Collapse:** Part of the basalt formation beneath Reynisfjall collapsed, narrowing the shoreline.
- **Climate Variability:** Changing wind and wave patterns may be linked to broader climatic instability.

INDIA:

PENNAIYAR RIVER



- The Pennaiyar River, also known as Thenpennai / Ponnaiyar in Tamil and Dakshina Pinakini in Kannada, is a major east-flowing inter-state river of southern India, significant for irrigation, industry, and water security in Tamil Nadu and Karnataka.

Origin:

- Originates in the **Nandi Hills, Chikkaballapura district**, Karnataka
- Arises from the Eastern Ghats system

States it flows through:

- **Karnataka** – Upper riparian state
- **Tamil Nadu** – Lower riparian state

Tamil Nadu is more dependent on the river for irrigation and drinking water, making downstream flows politically and economically sensitive.

Major tributaries of Pennaiyar:

- Markandeya River
- Varaha Nadhi
- Pambar River
- Pampar River

- *Markandeya River is central to the present inter-state dispute.*

Mouth:

- Empties into the Bay of Bengal
- Forms a **delta near Cuddalore**, Tamil Nadu

Key features:

- **Length:** ~497 km (second longest river in Tamil Nadu after Cauvery)
- **Nature:** Seasonal river; flows mainly during **South-West and North-East monsoons**
- **Major dams:**
 - Krishnagiri Dam
 - **Kelavarapalli Dam**
 - **Sathanur Dam** (largest; ~7.3 TMC gross capacity)
- **Economic role:**
 - Irrigates districts in **Karnataka (Chikkaballapura, Kolar, Bengaluru Rural/Urban) and Tamil Nadu (Krishnagiri, Dharmapuri, Tiruvannamalai, Villupuram, Cuddalore).**
- **Environmental concerns:**
 - Severe **industrial pollution** (notably from Bengaluru–Hosur belt).
 - **Sand mining** and shrinking perennial character.
- **Cultural significance:**
 - Mentioned in Sangam literature and **Tevaram hymns**.
 - Several ancient temples located along its banks.

KARIMPUZHA WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

- **Karimpuzha Wildlife Sanctuary** is a protected area in the **Western Ghats**, known for its exceptional biodiversity, wide altitudinal range, and intact forest ecosystems.

Located in:

- The sanctuary falls under the Nilambur forest landscape, an ecologically rich belt of the Western Ghats known for dense forests and high endemism.
- Its position on the Nilgiri slopes places it within a critical Western Ghats biodiversity hotspot, influencing rainfall, vegetation, and species

diversity.

Key geographical & ecological features:

- **Sharp altitudinal gradient (40 m to >2,550 m):** The wide elevation range creates varied climatic conditions, supporting species adapted to both lowland and montane ecosystems.
- **Seven forest types (unique in Kerala):** The coexistence of seven distinct forest types in one landscape makes it ecologically exceptional and highly biodiverse.
 - **Semi-evergreen & evergreen forests:** Support dense canopy, high rainfall species, and endemic flora.
 - **Moist deciduous forests:** Act as crucial habitats for large mammals and seasonal biodiversity.
 - **Sub-tropical savannah & hill forests:** Provide transitional ecosystems supporting grassland–forest species.
 - **Montane wet temperate forests & grasslands:** Sustain high-altitude endemics and regulate hydrology.
- **Ecological corridor:** By linking [Silent Valley National Park](#) and [Mukurthi National Park](#), it ensures habitat continuity for wildlife movement across state boundaries.
- **New Amarambalam Reserve inclusion:** This largely undisturbed forest tract preserves near-pristine ecosystems, serving as a genetic and ecological refuge within the Western Ghats.

Significance:

- Hosts key Western Ghats endemics such as [Nilgiri tahr](#) and lion-tailed macaque
- Rich diversity of birds, butterflies, odonates, amphibians, reptiles, and freshwater fish

COUNTRY'S FIRST UNDERWATER ROAD-CUM-RAIL TUNNEL UNDER BRAHMAPUTRA RIVER

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) has approved India's first underwater road-cum-rail tunnel under the Brahmaputra River in Assam.

What it is?

- A 33.7 km four-lane access-controlled Greenfield connectivity project, including a 15.79 km twin-tube underwater tunnel beneath the [Brahmaputra River](#) in Assam.
- It will connect Gohpur (NH-15) and Numaligarh (NH-715), reducing distance from 240 km to 34 km.

Key Features:

- **Twin-Tube Underwater Tunnel:** Two parallel tubes

ensure traffic segregation, safety redundancy, and easier emergency evacuation.

- **Road-cum-Rail Connectivity:** Combines highway and [railway infrastructure](#) to enable seamless passenger and freight movement.
- **EPC Mode Development:** Government funds the project while a contractor handles end-to-end execution under fixed timelines.

About Brahmaputra River:

The Brahmaputra River is one of the largest rivers of Central and South Asia and ranks among the world's top rivers in terms of average discharge.

Origin:

- Originates from the [Chemayungdung Glacier](#) near Lake Mapam in Tibet at ~5,300 m elevation.
- Known as **Yarlung Tsangpo** in Tibet, **Siang/Dihang** in Arunachal Pradesh, and **Jamuna** in Bangladesh.

Nations it flows through: China ([Tibet Autonomous Region](#)), India, and Bangladesh.

Indian States it flows through:

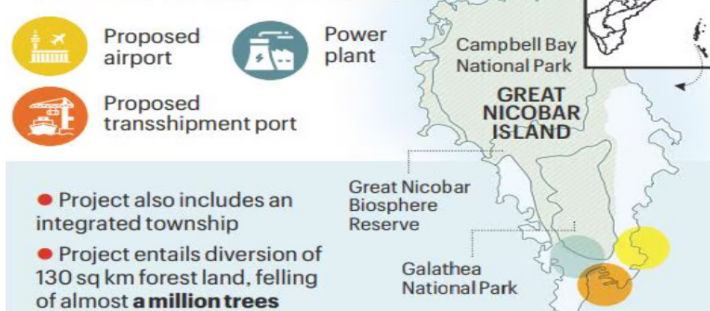
- Arunachal Pradesh
- Assam
- (Drainage basin also covers Nagaland, Meghalaya, West Bengal, and Sikkim)

Key Features of the Brahmaputra River:

- **Length – ~2,900 km:** Flows from the [Tibetan Plateau](#) to the Bay of Bengal, making it one of Asia's longest rivers.
- **Massive Discharge:** Among the world's highest river discharges, contributing significantly to the Ganga-Brahmaputra system.
- **World's Deepest Gorge:** Cuts through the [Yarlung Tsangpo Grand Canyon](#), one of the deepest gorges globally.
- **Highly Braided Channel:** In Assam, heavy sediment and reduced slope create multiple shifting river channels.
- **Delta Formation:** Merges with the Ganga to form the world's largest delta in Bangladesh.

NGT APPROVE GREAT NICOBAR PROJECT

• THE GREAT NICOBAR PROJECT



- The Great Nicobar Project is a **mega infrastructure development plan** valued at around ₹80,000 crore.
- It aims to transform Great Nicobar Island into a **strategic maritime and economic hub** in the [Indian Ocean Region](#) (IOR).

Location:

- Situated in **Great Nicobar Island**, the southernmost island of the Andaman and Nicobar archipelago.
- Lies close to the [Malacca Strait](#), one of the world's busiest shipping lanes.
- Spread over **166 sq km**, with diversion of around **130 sq km of forest land**.

Aim of the Project:

- The primary objective is to transform the island into a major economic and strategic hub. It aims to leverage the island's location near the Malacca Strait to boost India's maritime presence and [regional security](#).

Key Features:

- **International Transshipment Port:** A massive port facility designed to handle global shipping traffic.
- **Integrated Township:** Development of a modern urban center to support the project's activities.
- **Dual-Use Civil-Military Airport:** A strategic airfield intended for both commercial and defense purposes.
- **Power Infrastructure:** A 450-MVA hybrid gas and solar power plant to provide reliable energy.
- **Land Diversion:** The plan entails diverting 130 sq km of forest land and felling nearly one million trees.

RAVI RIVER



- The Ravi River is one of the five rivers of the Indus river system, which give Punjab its name ("Land of Five Rivers").
- It is an eastern river under the [Indus Waters Treaty](#), allocated exclusively to India.

Origin:

- Originates near the [Rohtang Pass](#) in Himachal Pradesh.
- Rises at an elevation of around **4,400 metres above sea level**.
- Initially flows as two streams — **Budhil and Tantgari** — which later merge.

Course of the River:

- **Countries:** Flows through **India and Pakistan**.
- **Within India:**
 - Himachal Pradesh (mainly Chamba district).
 - Punjab (Gurdaspur, Amritsar districts).
 - Forms part of the **India–Pakistan international boundary** before entering Pakistan.
- **In Pakistan:**
 - Flows past **Lahore**.
 - Eventually joins the [Chenab River](#).

Tributaries of Ravi River:

- **Right Bank Tributaries:** Siul River, Baira River, Budhil River, and Tant Gari
- **Left Bank Tributaries:** Ujh River and Chirchind Nala.
- **Other Tributaries / Streams:** Bhadal River, Sewa River, Bein and Basantar.

Ravi is a Tributary of: The Ravi River ultimately joins the **Chenab River**, which is a major western tributary of the Indus River.

Key Features of the Ravi River:

- The river flows through both India and Pakistan, with nearly half its course lying within Indian territory.
- **Catchment area in India:** A significant drainage basin in Himachal Pradesh and Punjab supports irrigation and hydropower projects.
- Flow is sustained by [Himalayan snowmelt](#) in summer and intensified by heavy monsoon rains from June to September.
- Intense rainfall often leads to high discharge levels, causing seasonal flooding in downstream areas.
- **Controlled by major dams** like Chamera I, II, III and Ranjit Sagar (Thein) Dam – These projects regulate water flow for hydropower generation, irrigation, and flood management.
- **Shahpur Kandi Dam:** A multipurpose project on the Ravi River near the Punjab–J&K border, aimed at utilising surplus eastern river [waters for irrigation](#) and reducing flow into Pakistan.